

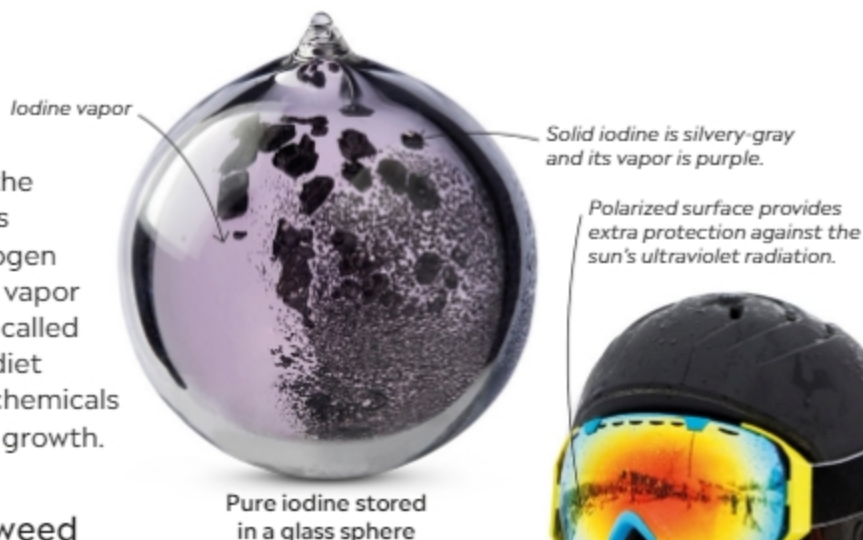
Iodine

53
I The name iodine comes from the Greek word *iodes*, which means “violet.” When heated, this halogen changes directly from a solid to a violet vapor without turning into a liquid—a process called sublimation. Iodine is important in our diet because it is vital to the production of chemicals that regulate body functions, including growth.



Seaweed diet

Most seaweed contains a large amount of iodine. The Japanese consume a lot of iodine, as a traditional Japanese diet will often include seaweed.



Pure iodine stored in a glass sphere

Protective eyewear

Polarized sunglasses are covered with a thin plastic film dipped in an iodine solution. This coating reduces the sun's harsh glare.

Many skiers use polarized glasses because sunlight reflecting off white snow can make it hard to see.

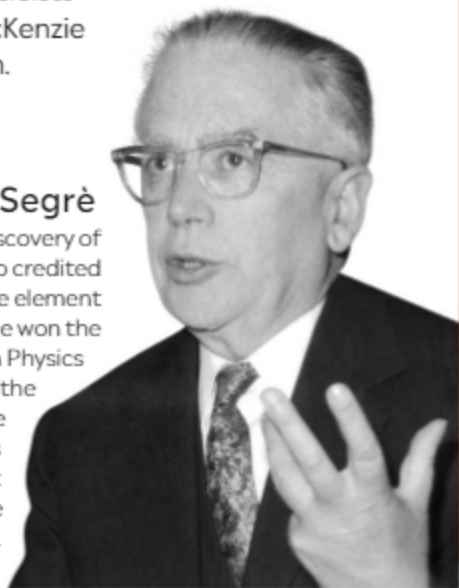


Astatine

85
At A highly radioactive element, astatine is also rare. A visible sample has never been prepared, because it's so radioactive it would immediately vaporize. It was first isolated in 1940 by Italian-American physicist Emilio Gino Segrè and US physicists Kenneth Ross MacKenzie and Dale R Corson.

Emilio Gino Segrè

In addition to his discovery of astatine, Segrè is also credited with discovering the element technetium. He won the 1959 Nobel Prize in Physics for his discovery of the antiproton—a particle with the same mass as a proton but with a negative electric charge.



Tennessine

117
Ts In November 2016, element 117 was named tennessine as a tribute to the state of Tennessee. This region is home to the Oak Ridge National Laboratory, which played a prominent role in the research that led to the discovery of this element.

A nuclear reactor at the Oak Ridge National Laboratory, in Tennessee

Researchers use a crane to move fuel rods into the reactor.

